

Word family: **exploit / exploited / exploiting / exploitation / exploitative / exploitable / exploiter**

Base word: exploit

Part of speech: **verb** and **noun**

Related forms:

* **exploit** (v.) — 剝削；利用；善用；開發

* **exploit** (n.) — 英勇 / 非凡事蹟；(電腦) 漏洞利用程式 / 攻擊手法

* **exploitation** (n.) — 剝削；利用；開發

* **exploitative** (adj.) — 剝削性的；利用他人的

* **exploitable** (adj.) — 可被利用的；可開發的；可被攻擊利用的

* **exploiter** (n.) — 剝削者；利用他人者

* **exploited** (adj./participle) — 被剝削的；被利用的

Pronunciation:

* **exploit** (verb): /ɪk'splɔɪt/ — stress on second syllable

* **exploit** (noun): /'eksplɔɪt/ — stress on first syllable

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **exploit workers**

* **exploit cheap labour**

* **exploit vulnerable people**

* **exploit someone's weakness**

* **exploit a loophole**

* **exploit an opportunity**

* **exploit an advantage**

* **exploit resources**

* **exploit natural resources**

* **commercial exploitation**

* **labour exploitation**

* **economic exploitation**

* **exploitation of workers**

* **exploitative working conditions**

* **feel exploited**

* **exploit a vulnerability**

* **security exploit**

* **software exploit**

* **historic / military exploits**

Meaning in this passage

> When accountability is built into the system, teamwork stops feeling like **exploitation** and starts feeling like genuine collaboration.

The passage uses the noun **exploitation**, from **exploit**.

Here:

exploit someone = to unfairly use another person's work, weakness, or situation for your own benefit — 剝削；不公平地利用

The hardworking team members may feel that other members are benefiting from their effort without doing a fair share themselves.

中文翻譯：

當制度加入問責機制後，團隊合作便不再令人覺得是一種**剝削 / 被人佔便宜**，而開始像真正的合作。

So the family meaning here is:

exploit / exploitation = 一方從另一方的工作或處境中取得利益，但沒有給予公平回報或承擔公平份量

1. **exploit someone** — 剝削某人；利用某人

This is the exact semantic branch behind your passage.

Practice 1 — original sense

> Without clear accountability, diligent workers may feel **exploited** by teammates who contribute very little.

如果缺乏清晰的問責制度，勤奮員工可能會覺得自己被貢獻很少的組員**佔便宜 / 剝削**。

Practice 2

> Employers should never **exploit workers** simply because they have few alternatives.

僱主不應因為員工選擇不多便**剝削他們**。

Practice 3

> He felt that his colleagues were **exploiting** his willingness to help.

他覺得同事正在**利用他樂於助人的性格佔便宜**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit someone = 不公平地利用某人的工作、弱勢或處境，以令自己得益****

2. ****exploit workers / labour — 剝削工人 / 勞工****

Practice 1

> Some companies have been accused of ****exploiting workers****.

有些公司被指控****剝削工人****。

Practice 2

> Strong labour laws can help prevent companies from ****exploiting cheap labour****.

完善的勞工法例可以防止公司****剝削廉價勞工****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit workers/labour = 從工人的工作中獲利，卻給予不公平的薪酬、待遇或工作條件****

3. ****exploit vulnerable people — 利用弱勢人士****

Practice 1

> Fraudsters often try to ****exploit vulnerable people****.

騙徒經常嘗試****利用弱勢人士****。

Practice 2

> The organisation was criticised for ****exploiting people in financial difficulty****.

該機構因****利用經濟困難人士的處境牟利****而受到批評。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit vulnerable people = 利用他人的弱勢、困難或缺乏選擇來取得不公平利益****

4. ****exploit someone's weakness — 利用某人的弱點****

Practice 1

> A manipulative colleague may **exploit your weakness**.

善於操控別人的同事可能會**利用你的弱點**。

Practice 2

> The opponent quickly **exploited the team's defensive weakness**.

對手很快便**利用了球隊防守上的弱點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploit a weakness = 找到某個弱點並利用它為自己取得優勢

This can range from morally negative to strategically neutral depending on context.

5. **feel exploited — 覺得被剝削 / 被人佔便宜**

Very relevant to your teamwork passage.

Practice 1

> Employees may **feel exploited** when they do most of the work but receive the same credit as everyone else.

如果員工做了大部分工作，卻只得到和其他人相同的功勞，他們可能會**覺得被佔便宜**。

Practice 2

> She left because she felt **overworked and exploited**.

她因為覺得自己工作過量又**受到剝削**而離職。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel exploited = 覺得別人在不公平地利用自己的工作、時間或善意

6. **exploitation (剝削) — 剝削 ; 不公平利用**

This is the exact word used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Teamwork stops feeling like **exploitation** and starts feeling like genuine collaboration.

團隊合作不再令人覺得是一種**剝削**，而開始像真正的合作。

Practice 2

> The policy was introduced to prevent the **exploitation of workers**.

政策的目的之一是防止**剝削工人**。

Practice 3

> Unequal group work can create a sense of **exploitation**.

不公平的小組工作可能令人產生**被人佔便宜的感覺**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploitation = 不公平地利用某人或某群體以使自己獲利的行為或制度

7. **labour / worker exploitation — 勞工剝削**

Practice 1

> The report examined cases of **labour exploitation**.

報告研究了多宗**勞工剝削**個案。

Practice 2

> Low wages and unsafe conditions may be signs of **worker exploitation**.

低薪和不安全的工作環境可能是**剝削工人**的跡象。

MCQ-ready definition:

labour exploitation = 對勞工的工作、薪酬或處境作不公平利用

8. **economic exploitation — 經濟剝削**

Practice 1

> Critics described the arrangement as a form of **economic exploitation**.

批評者形容這項安排是一種**經濟剝削**。

Practice 2

> The law aims to protect vulnerable groups from **economic exploitation**.

該法例旨在保護弱勢群體免受**經濟剝削**。

MCQ-ready definition:

economic exploitation = 利用權力或經濟上的不平等，從另一方取得不公平利益

9. **exploitative** — 剝削性的；利用他人的

Practice 1

> Workers complained about **exploitative working conditions**.

工人投訴**具剝削性的工作環境**。

Practice 2

> The agreement was criticised as **exploitative**.

這項協議被批評為**不公平剝削另一方的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploitative = 以不公平方式利用他人來取得利益的

10. **exploitative relationship** — 剝削性的關係

Practice 1

> A healthy partnership should not become an **exploitative relationship**.

健康的合作關係不應變成**一方剝削另一方的關係**。

Practice 2

> The arrangement became increasingly **exploitative**.

這項安排變得愈來愈**不公平和具剝削性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploitative relationship = 一方持續從另一方取得不公平利益的關係****

11. ****exploit an opportunity — 把握 / 善用機會****

A second major branch.

Here, ****exploit**** does ****not necessarily mean something immoral****.

It can simply mean:

**make full or effective use of something**

Practice 1

> The company moved quickly to ****exploit the new market opportunity****.

公司迅速採取行動，****把握新的市場機會****。

Practice 2

> Good managers know how to ****exploit opportunities for growth****.

優秀的管理人員懂得如何****善用增長機會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit an opportunity = 充分利用一個機會以取得最大好處****

12. ****exploit an advantage — 善用優勢****

Practice 1

> The team successfully ****exploited its technical advantage****.

團隊成功****善用了技術優勢****。

Practice 2

> Small companies can sometimes ****exploit their flexibility****.

小型公司有時可以**善用自身靈活性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit an advantage = 充分使用已有的優勢來取得更好結果****

13. ****exploit someone's mistake — 利用某人的錯誤取得優勢****

Practice 1

> The opposing team ****exploited several defensive mistakes****.

對手****利用了幾次防守失誤****取得優勢。

Practice 2

> Competitors may ****exploit any mistake**** the company makes.

競爭對手可能會****利用公司犯下的任何錯誤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit a mistake = 把別人的錯誤轉化為自己的優勢****

Usually strategic rather than morally “exploitative”.

14. ****exploit a loophole — 利用漏洞****

A common expression.

Practice 1

> Some businesses tried to ****exploit a loophole in the rules****.

有些企業嘗試****鑽規則的漏洞****。

Practice 2

> The law was changed after people began ****exploiting the loophole****.

有人開始****利用該漏洞****後，法律便被修改。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit a loophole = 利用規則或法律中的漏洞來取得原本未預期的利益****

This often carries a negative or questionable nuance.

15. **exploit a situation — 利用局勢 / 情況**

Practice 1

> The company tried to **exploit the sudden rise in demand**.

公司試圖**利用需求突然上升的情況**。

Practice 2

> He was accused of **exploiting the situation for personal gain**.

他被指控**利用局勢為自己謀利**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploit a situation = 利用某種情況來取得好處

The moral tone depends on context.

16. **exploit resources — 利用 / 開發資源**

A third major branch.

Practice 1

> The country began to **exploit its natural resources**.

該國開始**開發天然資源**。

Practice 2

> New technology allows companies to **exploit resources more efficiently**.

新科技令企業能更有效地**利用資源**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploit resources = 開發或使用資源，以從中取得實際或經濟價值

17. **exploit natural resources** — 開發天然資源

Practice 1

> The region has considerable potential to **exploit renewable resources**.

該地區很有潛力**開發可再生資源**。

Practice 2

> Natural resources should not be **exploited without regard for the environment**.

不應在完全不顧環境後果的情況下**開發天然資源**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploit natural resources = 開採、開發或使用自然界的資源以取得價值

Note that this can be neutral, but context can make it negative if the use is excessive or damaging.

18. **exploitation of natural resources** — 天然資源開發 / 利用

Practice 1

> The **exploitation of natural resources** created jobs.

天然資源的開發創造了就業機會。

Practice 2

> Excessive **exploitation of natural resources** can damage ecosystems.

過度**開發天然資源**可能破壞生態系統。

MCQ-ready definition:

resource exploitation = 對天然資源進行開採、開發或利用

Notice that **exploitation** here may translate as **開發**, not necessarily **剝削**.

19. **commercial exploitation** — 商業利用；商業開發

Practice 1

> The invention has potential for **commercial exploitation**.

這項發明具有**商業開發 / 商業利用**的潛力。

Practice 2

> The agreement controls the **commercial exploitation of the technology**.

協議規管該項科技的**商業利用**。

MCQ-ready definition:

commercial exploitation = 把某項資產、技術、作品或機會用於商業盈利

This can be neutral.

20. **exploit data / technology — 善用資料 / 科技**

Practice 1

> Companies increasingly **exploit data to improve decision-making**.

企業愈來愈懂得**善用數據改善決策**。

Practice 2

> The team failed to fully **exploit the available technology**.

團隊未能充分**利用現有科技**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exploit data/technology = 充分利用已有資料或科技的價值

In formal business writing, this can be neutral or positive.

21. **exploit a vulnerability — 利用漏洞 / 弱點**

A major cybersecurity sense.

Practice 1

> Attackers **exploited a vulnerability in the software**.

攻擊者**利用了軟件中的漏洞**。

Practice 2

> The update prevents criminals from **exploiting the security flaw**.

更新可以防止犯罪者**利用這個安全漏洞**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploit a vulnerability = 利用系統、軟件或保安措施中的弱點來取得未經授權的效果****

22. ****exploit (noun, cybersecurity) — 漏洞利用程式 / 攻擊手法****

Here ****exploit**** is a countable noun.

Practice 1

> The attacker used an ****exploit**** to gain access to the system.

攻擊者使用一個****漏洞利用程式 / 攻擊手法****進入系統。

Practice 2

> A public ****exploit**** was released for the vulnerability.

有人公開了針對該漏洞的****利用程式 / 攻擊方法****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an exploit = 利用軟件或系統漏洞來產生某種效果的程式碼、工具或技術****

23. ****zero-day exploit — 零日漏洞利用程式 / 攻擊****

A common cybersecurity compound.

Practice 1

> The attack involved a ****zero-day exploit****.

這次攻擊涉及一個****零日漏洞利用手法****。

Practice 2

> Zero-day exploits can be especially difficult to defend against.

****零日漏洞利用攻擊****可能特別難防範。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****zero-day exploit = 利用尚未被修補、甚至尚未被供應商充分知悉的漏洞進行攻擊的方法或程式碼****

24. ****exploitable vulnerability — 可被利用的漏洞****

Practice 1

> The scanner identified several ****exploitable vulnerabilities****.

掃描工具發現了數個****可被利用的漏洞****。

Practice 2

> Not every software bug is easily ****exploitable****.

並非每個軟件錯誤都很容易****被攻擊者利用****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploitable = 可以實際被利用來取得某種效果的****

25. ****exploitable resource / opportunity — 可開發 / 可利用的資源或機會****

Practice 1

> The region contains commercially ****exploitable resources****.

該地區擁有具商業價值、****可以開發的資源****。

Practice 2

> Researchers identified an ****exploitable opportunity**** for improvement.

研究人員找到了一個****可以善加利用的改善機會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exploitable = 可以被有效利用或開發的****

26. **exploit** (noun : 英勇 / 非凡事蹟) — 英勇事蹟 ; 非凡成就

A completely separate noun sense.

Remember the pronunciation changes:

noun **exploit** → /'eksplɔɪt/

Practice 1

> The book tells of the explorer's remarkable **exploits**.

這本書講述那名探險家的非凡**事蹟**。

Practice 2

> His sporting **exploits** made him famous.

他在運動場上的非凡**成就 / 事蹟**令他成名。

MCQ-ready definition:

an exploit = 一項勇敢、精彩、困難或值得注意的行動或成就

Usually plural:

> **exploits**

is especially common.

27. **military exploits** — 軍事功績 / 戰績

Practice 1

> The biography describes his military **exploits**.

傳記描述了他的**軍事戰績**。

Practice 2

> Stories of the commander's **exploits** spread quickly.

關於那位指揮官**英勇事蹟**的故事很快傳開。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****military exploits = 戰爭或軍事行動中值得注意的功績或事蹟****

28. ****sporting exploits — 體育上的非凡成就****

Practice 1

> She became famous for her sporting ****exploits****.

她因體育方面的非凡****成就****而成名。

Practice 2

> His latest ****exploits on the football field**** impressed supporters.

他最近在足球場上的出色****表現 / 事蹟****令支持者印象深刻。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sporting exploits = 運動中令人印象深刻的成就或表現****

Important distinction 1: ****exploit vs use****

This is the biggest distinction.

****use****

neutral and extremely broad.

****exploit****

can mean:

1. ****use unfairly**** → 剝削
2. ****make full use of**** → 充分利用

Compare:

- > use an opportunity
- > 利用機會

> exploit an opportunity
> **充分把握 / 善用**機會

> use a worker's skills
> 運用員工技能

> exploit a worker
> **剝削員工**

Context is crucial.

Important distinction 2: **exploit someone vs exploit something**

This often determines the moral tone.

exploit a person

usually strongly negative:

> exploit workers
> 剝削工人

exploit an opportunity/resource

can be neutral:

> exploit an opportunity
> 善用機會

> exploit mineral resources
> 開發礦產資源

But something can still be negative depending on context:

> exploit a legal loophole
> 鑽法律漏洞

Important distinction 3: **exploit vs take advantage of**

These overlap strongly.

take advantage of a person

usually negative:

> exploit them.

take advantage of an opportunity

positive/neutral:

> make good use of it.

Exploit has the same duality but is often stronger and more formal.

Important distinction 4: **exploit vs abuse**

exploit

unfairly use someone/something for benefit.

abuse

misuse, mistreat, or harm.

> exploit workers for profit

> 剝削員工牟利

> abuse workers verbally

> 言語虐待員工

The two may occur together, but they are not synonyms.

Important distinction 5: **exploit vs manipulate**

manipulate

control or influence someone, often secretly or unfairly.

exploit

gain benefit from someone's situation, weakness, or work.

> manipulate someone into agreeing

> 操控某人令其同意

> exploit someone's willingness to help

> 利用某人的善意佔便宜

Important distinction 6: **exploit vs oppress**

exploit

gain unfair benefit from someone.

oppress

keep a group under harsh, unjust control.

Exploitation can form part of oppression, but the concepts are different.

Important distinction 7: **exploit vs develop resources**

develop resources

prepare and expand their use.

exploit resources

extract or use their economic/practical value.

> develop renewable energy capacity

> 發展再生能源能力

> exploit an oil field

> 開發油田

Exploit emphasizes extracting useful value.

Important distinction 8: **exploitation can be neutral or negative**

This is extremely important.

Human context:

- > exploitation of workers
- > ****剝削工人**** — strongly negative

Resource/business context:

- > exploitation of mineral resources
- > ****礦產資源開發**** — can be neutral

Technology:

- > commercial exploitation of a patent
- > ****專利的商業利用**** — neutral

So do ****not**** automatically translate every ****exploitation**** as 「剝削」.

Important distinction 9: ****exploit opportunity vs seize opportunity****

****seize an opportunity****

act quickly to take the opportunity.

****exploit an opportunity****

make maximum practical use of it.

- > seize the opportunity to enter the market
- > 把握進入市場的機會

- > exploit the opportunity to expand sales
- > 充分利用這個機會擴大銷售

Important distinction 10: ****exploit weakness vs attack weakness****

****attack a weakness****

directly target it.

****exploit a weakness****

use it strategically to gain an advantage.

The latter focuses more on turning the weakness into a benefit for yourself.

Important distinction 11: **exploit a loophole**

A loophole is not necessarily a software vulnerability.

Legal/rule context:

> exploit a loophole

> **鑽漏洞**

Cybersecurity:

> exploit a vulnerability

> **利用保安漏洞進行攻擊**

Related metaphor, different domains.

Important distinction 12: **exploit noun vs verb pronunciation**

Very important learner point.

Verb:

> to ex**PLOIT** workers

> /ɪk'splɔɪt/

Noun:

> heroic **EX**ploit

> /'eksplɔɪt/

So the stress shifts.

Important distinction 13: **an exploit vs exploitation**

an exploit

a remarkable deed:

> heroic exploits

> 英勇事蹟

exploitation

use/abuse/development:

> worker exploitation

> 勞工剝削

Do not treat noun **exploit** as simply the noun form of “to exploit someone”.

For the unfair-use meaning, the normal noun is:

exploitation

Important distinction 14: **exploitative vs exploited**

exploitative

does the exploiting:

> exploitative employer

> 剝削員工的僱主

exploited

receives the unfair treatment:

> exploited workers

> 受剝削的工人

Direction matters.

Important distinction 15: **exploitable**

This means:

capable of being exploited

but the translation changes:

> exploitable worker
> 容易被人利用的人

> exploitable resource
> 可開發資源

> exploitable vulnerability
> 可被利用的漏洞

Same English adjective, different natural Chinese.

Important distinction 16: **exploitation vs collaboration**

This is the contrast explicitly built into your passage.

collaboration

different people contribute toward a shared goal in a cooperative way.

exploitation

one side benefits disproportionately from another side's effort.

So badly managed teamwork can look like:

> hardworking members → carry most of the burden
> low-contributing members → receive equal credit

That imbalance makes “collaboration” feel like **exploitation**.

Important distinction 17: **exploit vs benefit from**

benefit from

simply receive an advantage.

exploit

actively use something or someone to gain that advantage.

> Everyone benefited from her research.
> 大家都從她的研究得益。

> They exploited her willingness to do extra work.
> 他們**利用她願意做額外工作的心態佔便宜**。

Important distinction 18: **exploit in your passage**

The paragraph does **not** mean workers are being formally exploited in a legal or employment-law sense.

The writer uses **exploitation** more broadly to describe the workers' perception:

"I do most of the work, while someone else receives the same benefit."

That feels exploitative because:

- * effort is unequal,
- * contribution is unequal,
- * credit remains equal.

Family-extension note

The **exploit** family has four major modern branches:

1. **unfairly use people**

- * exploit workers
- * exploit vulnerable people
- * exploitation
- * exploitative

2. **make effective use of something**

- * exploit an opportunity
- * exploit an advantage
- * exploit a weakness

3. **develop/use resources**

- * exploit natural resources
- * commercial exploitation

4. **cybersecurity**

- * exploit a vulnerability
- * a software exploit

And one completely separate noun branch:

5. **remarkable deed**

- * heroic exploits
- * sporting exploits

For your passage, the exact branch is:

exploitation = unfairly benefiting from other team members' work while not carrying a fair share of the burden

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
exploit someone	剝削 / 利用某人	unfair personal benefit
exploit workers	剝削工人	labour
exploit vulnerability in a person	利用弱點	unfair advantage
feel exploited	覺得被剝削 / 佔便宜	victim perspective
exploitation	剝削；不公平利用	unfair use
labour exploitation	勞工剝削	workplace
economic exploitation	經濟剝削	financial inequality
exploitative	剝削性的	unfair behaviour
exploit an opportunity	善用 / 把握機會	maximize benefit
exploit an advantage	善用優勢	strategic use
exploit a weakness	利用弱點	strategic advantage
exploit a loophole	鑽漏洞	rule weakness
exploit a situation	利用局勢	situational advantage
exploit resources	利用 / 開發資源	resource use
natural-resource exploitation	天然資源開發	extraction/use
commercial exploitation	商業利用	commercial value
exploit data/technology	善用資料 / 科技	productive use
exploit a vulnerability	利用安全漏洞	cybersecurity
an exploit (cyber)	漏洞利用程式 / 手法	technical attack
zero-day exploit	零日漏洞利用	cybersecurity
exploitable	可利用 / 可開發的	capable of exploitation
an exploit (deed)	非凡 / 英勇事蹟	remarkable action
military exploits	軍事功績	achievements
sporting exploits	體育上的非凡成就	achievements

For your original sentence

> When accountability is built into the system, teamwork stops feeling like **exploitation** and starts feeling like genuine collaboration.

Here:

exploitation = 勤奮成員承擔大部分工作和責任，而投入較少的成員卻同樣享受成果和功勞，因此前者覺得自己的努力被別人不公平地利用

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當問責機制被納入制度後，團隊合作便不再令人覺得是**被人佔便宜 / 受到剝削**，而開始真正像是彼此合作。

The cleanest contrast is:

- > **use** = 使用，中性
- > **benefit from** = 從.....得益
- > **take advantage of** = 利用；也可指佔便宜
- > **exploit** = 利用某人 / 某事來取得最大利益；對人使用時通常帶有「不公平剝削」意味
- > **collaborate** = 共同合作、共同承擔

And in this paragraph the logic is especially clear:

- > **unequal effort + unequal contribution + equal credit → feeling exploited**
- > **clear roles + measurable output + accountability → genuine collaboration**